

State Transition Testing

A technique for validating behavior when outcomes depend on the current state and occurring events.

Model

Identify states, events, valid/invalid transitions and resulting actions.

Examples

Order: created → paid → shipped → delivered; account: active → locked → reactivated; session: authenticated → expired.

Coverage

Test valid paths, forbidden events, repetition, wrong order and final states.

History

Defects may depend on previous sequence; record initial state and events for reproducibility.

QA Tip: When the same event produces different outcomes depending on current state, model transitions explicitly.